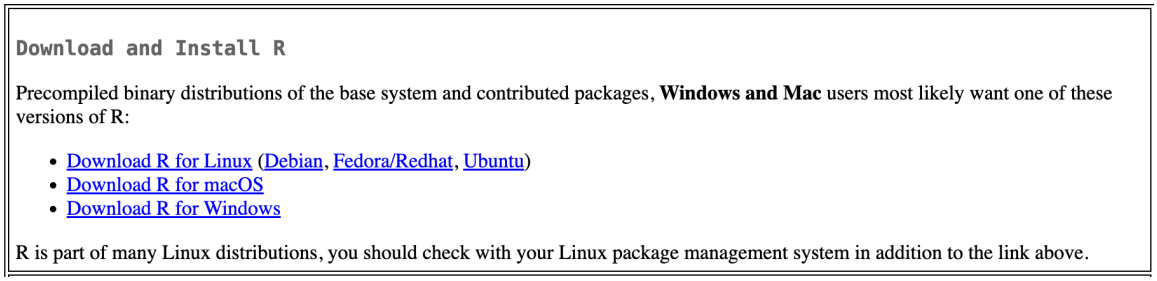
Please follow these instructions to download R and R Studio onto your computer.

1. Click on this link: https://archive.linux.duke.edu/cran/

2. The top of this page should now have a section that looks similar to this. Click on the download button that best matches the type of computer that you have. For example, if you have a MacBook, click “Download R for macOS”. If you have a Windows computer, click “Download R for Windows”.



Download and Install R

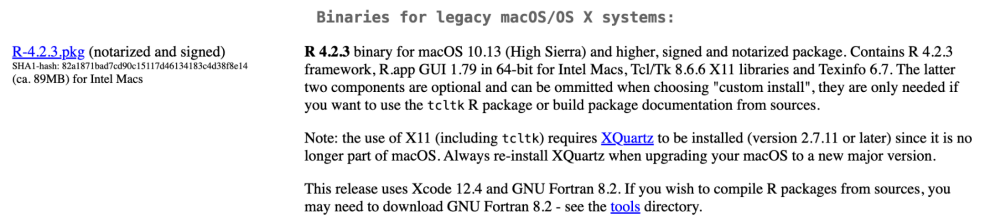
Precompiled binary distributions of the base system and contributed packages, **Windows and Mac** users most likely want one of these versions of R:

- Download R for Linux (Debian, Fedora/Redhat, Ubuntu)
- Download R for macOS
- Download R for Windows

R is part of many Linux distributions, you should check with your Linux package management system in addition to the link above.

3. Now, we need to download a version of R. For Mac users, we will use R 4.6.1, codenamed "Happy Hop" which is the newest version. Click download on that version. For Windows users, click the button that says: “install R for the first time” to download the current version of R.

Mac Users:



Binaries for legacy macOS/OS X systems:

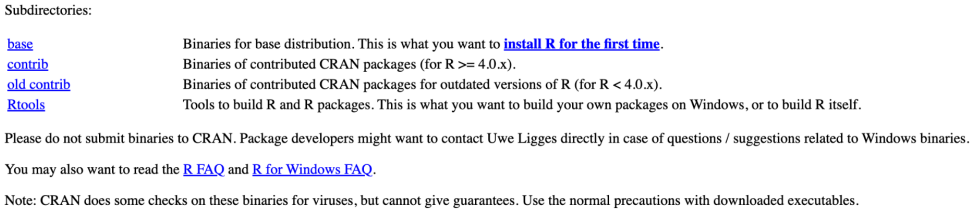
R-4.2.3.pkg (notarized and signed)
SHA1-hash: 82a1871bad7cd90c15117d46134183c4d38f8e14
(ca. 89MB) for Intel Macs

R 4.2.3 binary for macOS 10.13 (High Sierra) and higher, signed and notarized package. Contains R 4.2.3 framework, R.app GUI 1.79 in 64-bit for Intel Macs, Tcl/Tk 8.6.6 X11 libraries and Texinfo 6.7. The latter two components are optional and can be ommitted when choosing "custom install", they are only needed if you want to use the `tcltk` R package or build package documentation from sources.

Note: the use of X11 (including `tcltk`) requires XQuartz to be installed (version 2.7.11 or later) since it is no longer part of macOS. Always re-install XQuartz when upgrading your macOS to a new major version.

This release uses Xcode 12.4 and GNU Fortran 8.2. If you wish to compile R packages from sources, you may need to download GNU Fortran 8.2 - see the tools directory.

Windows Users:



Subdirectories:

base	Binaries for base distribution. This is what you want to **install R for the first time**.
contrib	Binaries of contributed CRAN packages (for R >= 4.0.x).
old contrib	Binaries of contributed CRAN packages for outdated versions of R (for R < 4.0.x).
Rtools	Tools to build R and R packages. This is what you want to build your own packages on Windows, or to build R itself.

Please do not submit binaries to CRAN. Package developers might want to contact Uwe Ligges directly in case of questions / suggestions related to Windows binaries.

You may also want to read the R FAQ and R for Windows FAQ.

Note: CRAN does some checks on these binaries for viruses, but cannot give guarantees. Use the normal precautions with downloaded executables.

4. Once this downloads onto your computer, open the .**pkg** file with your package manager and install R on your computer (defaults should generally be fine).

5. Once you install R and see this on your desktop, we also need to download R Studio. Click on this link: https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop/#download

6. Scroll down until you see the links shown in the picture below. Again, make sure you are downloading the correct version of R Studio depending on if you have Windows or a Mac just like we did above. For Mac Users, you will need to know your current MacOS version so you can download the correct version of R Studio. If you want to verify, you can go to Settings, click General, and click Software Update to see what your current update is.



OS	Download	Size	SHA-256
Windows 10/11	RSTUDIO-2026.01.0-392.EXE	314.17 MB	525403C0
macOS 14/15/26	RSTUDIO-2026.01.0-392.DMG	670.03 MB	EE3F39BB

7. Once this downloads, there is a **.exe** file for Windows based computers and a .dmg file for mac based computers. Use these to install and open RStudio.

Once you go through all 7 of these steps, you are good to go! You should now be able to open RStudio and have access to a great coding environment that we'll use throughout this course!